

Chapter 44-2

Liang Shi let out a gentle breath.

If she had come before, that meant it was before she was eight years old.

So did the eight-year-old her exist in this world at the same time as the original owner?

Or did they switch places?

Both possibilities existed, but Liang Shi was more inclined toward the second possibility.

Had she come during some time period before age eight? Or had she originally been living in this world?

Liang Shi felt... this still needed further investigation.

However, now she knew that she couldn't reveal too much information about herself to Xu Qingzhu, especially the fact that she had transmigrated into a book. This would be considered cheating by the system.

But that picture was something Xu Qingzhu had discovered first. Would talking about things related to the picture while speaking from the original owner's perspective also count as self-exposure?

[Ding dong! Little System is back! Very sorry, host. Anything you do from the original owner's perspective doesn't count as self-exposure, but using this method to gain your target's trust counts as cheating. Your luck points accumulated fifteen points in an instant just now, so it was deemed a violation.]

[Due to the time rewind, your luck points have returned to their previous value. Please keep up the good work.]

[PS: You could speak more slowly, so you won't accumulate large amounts of luck points in a short period and be deemed in violation!]

Liang Shi: "....."

You're really a little genius.

But having just gone through such inhumane torture, Liang Shi didn't want to talk to it much.

The only thing she said was: "Why doesn't the Resentment Management Bureau punish you? You were clearly the one who disrupted order first."

The mechanical voice fell silent. After a moment, it mimicked humans' pitiful tone and said: [Wuu wuu, host, don't you like me anymore? I've already been so lenient with you, I've put all my tears into it!]

Liang Shi: "....."

Please just scram quickly, okay?

[Your insults have been received by Little System. After finishing talking with you, Little System will return to headquarters to receive punishment and replace the chip. Next, Little System's colleague will come to take care of you. You must work hard to complete your mission!]

Liang Shi: "....."

Nagged eight times a day.

Really!

Even office workers get vacation time! She worked twenty-four hours without rest and had to deal with punishments from time to time. How could one word describe such misery?

Liang Shi placated it, then the system quietly disappeared.

She came back to her senses and found herself and Xu Qingzhu standing at the entrance. She quickly opened the door.

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After that, everything proceeded the same as before, even the height at which Xu Qingzhu hung her coat was identical.

So time rewind wouldn't change anything.

After hearing Xu Qingzhu's words, Liang Shi still remained silent.

She looked at Xu Qingzhu and first poured her a glass of water, her voice gentle: "Drink some water first, let's talk slowly."

Yes, talk slowly so the luck points would accumulate more slowly.

Xu Qingzhu still looked tired. She took the water Liang Shi handed her and only took a light sip before placing the glass back on the coffee table.

Liang Shi said: "Wait for me to think about where to start with you, okay?"

Xu Qingzhu looked at her: "I already said, you don't need to think about how to make up lies to fool me. If you're willing to talk, I'll listen. If you're not willing, I'll go upstairs to sleep. I don't want to hear lies."

Liang Shi nodded: "I know. Don't get worked up first. I promise every word I tell you will be true, it's just that the story is very long."

"Then give me the short version," Xu Qingzhu said straightforwardly.

Liang Shi: "....."

"I need to organize my thoughts," Liang Shi said, pausing before asking: "Do you remember the phone call I had with my mom at the hospital?"

Xu Qingzhu thought for a moment, then nodded.

That day, Liang Shi had questioned Qiu Zimin¹ about why she wanted to use her to make a deal with Zhou Yi'an.

Qiu Zimin's answer had been quite cutting too.

However, Xu Qingzhu's emotions had been very poor that day, so bad that she had almost wanted to ask Liang Shi for a hug.

She hadn't paid much attention to this matter. Every family had their own difficult scriptures to recite.

Especially in large families, enjoying privileges meant paying a price.

Families that sent their beloved daughters into arranged marriages were everywhere. The Liang family was simply no exception.

It wasn't anything special.

However, what puzzled her was why Qiu Zimin said that plot of land in the south of the city was especially important to the Liang family. What use would a company that made luxury goods have for a plot of land? How could it reach the point where not getting the land would mean bankruptcy?

During that period, Xu Qingzhu had so many messes of her own to deal with that she had no time to think about matters concerning Liang Shi, so she didn't investigate further. Thinking about it now, there were indeed many suspicious points.

"I remember some of it," Xu Qingzhu answered conservatively, though she actually remembered most of it.

This was probably the advantage of having a good memory.

"At that time, she wanted to introduce me to Zhou Yi'an, wanting to use me to exchange for that plot of land in the south of the city. She even wanted to encourage me to undergo differentiation surgery². To undergo secondary differentiation when I was perfectly healthy—this doesn't seem like something a mother would do, right?" Liang Shi spoke about this matter very calmly while also answering another question: "After waking up from the hospital, I lost many memories. You know that, right?"

Xu Qingzhu looked at her: "So you have amnesia, not soul replacement? Are you certain?"

She restrained her gentle aura, and when she looked over intently, there was a somewhat oppressive feeling. Those clear eyes made one's heart involuntarily beat faster.

Liang Shi turned her face away and sighed lightly: "Can I remain silent on this question?"

Xu Qingzhu paused, then answered: "Yes."

"Because I myself have many questions that I haven't figured out yet," Liang Shi said. "As you said, I am free. I don't want to answer you with things I haven't figured out myself, which means I don't want to lie to you."

Xu Qingzhu: "...Alright."

"You went through my phone last time, didn't you?" Liang Shi asked her.

The strange image suddenly appeared in Xu Qingzhu's mind, instantly making her scalp tingle, but she still took a deep breath and said: "Yes, I apologize for that. It's because I wanted too much to know why you had changed like this."

"Is this version of me not good?" Liang Shi asked.

Xu Qingzhu smiled: "Very good. But do you know how distressing it is for me to think every day about the question of who you really are?"

"I am Liang Shi," Liang Shi said with firm conviction and a smile. "I am Liang Shi. This is beyond doubt."

In her original world, she was also called Liang Shi.

Xu Qingzhu nodded, not dwelling on this question: "Continue."

"The bottom right corner of that photo said 'sacrifice,'" Liang Shi said. "I don't remember this incident, but I went back to the old mansion. Have you ever been in my room?"

Xu Qingzhu shook her head: "After we got married, we moved to this villa. When I visited your home before marriage, I never spent the night there, and no one suggested you show me around your room."

Footnotes:

¹ Qiu Zimin: Liang Shi's adoptive mother in the Liang family

² Differentiation surgery: In ABO dynamics, a medical procedure to change one's secondary gender (Alpha, Beta, or Omega status)